

SMITA SAHU

Principal Backend Engineer | AI Explorer | CCDV-F in Progress

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Principal Backend Engineer with 13+ years of experience designing and scaling enterprise-grade microservices, event-driven architectures, and cloud-native systems in banking, fintech, telecom, and consumer goods sectors. My career has evolved from writing performant backend code to defining technical strategies that enable engineering teams to deliver faster, scale reliably, and maintain architectural integrity across global deployments.

Currently, I lead backend engineering strategies for Tier-1 banking platforms at Backbase, managing the full SDLC for microservices serving millions of users across North America and MEA. I operate with a 'Platform Engineering' mindset within enterprise environments—constantly looking for ways to reduce deployment friction, automate infrastructure workflows, and create reusable architectural patterns that eliminate technical debt and accelerate time-to-market.

Core Focus Areas: ■ Developer Experience – Establishing standardized CI/CD pipelines, API frameworks, and DevOps tooling to boost team velocity. ■ AI Exploration – Learning and exploring Generative AI and LLMs (Python, Claude API) to understand their potential in backend systems and code generation. ■ Leadership & Mentorship – Building high-performing backend teams through structured mentorship, architectural reviews, and fostering a culture of technical excellence.

Technical Stack: Java 8+, Spring Boot, Python, Node.js, Microservices, Event-Driven Architecture, CQRS, Kubernetes, Docker, Azure, AWS, CI/CD (Jenkins, GitLab CI), Databases (SQL, NoSQL), and Generative AI (Claude API, LLMs).

CORE COMPETENCIES

Backend & Architecture	Java 8+, Spring Boot, Spring MVC, Microservices, Event-driven design, CQRS, Event Sourcing, REST APIs, API In
Cloud & Infrastructure	Azure (Blob, Cosmos DB, AD, SQL), AWS, GCP, Kubernetes, Docker, Firebase, CI/CD Pipelines
Databases	MySQL, Oracle, Azure SQL, MongoDB, DynamoDB, Firestore, Neo4j, PostgreSQL
Languages & Frameworks	Java, Python, Node.js, Spring Boot, Flask, Django
AI & GenAI	Generative AI, LLMs, Claude API, Python-based AI exploration, Prompt engineering, Learning LLM applications
DevOps & Tools	CI/CD, GitLab, GitHub, Jenkins, Azure DevOps, Docker, Kubernetes, Camunda BPMN, DataDog, Splunk, Grafana
Methodologies	TDD, BDD, Agile/Scrum, Domain-Driven Design, Platform Engineering, Microservices Architecture

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Principal Backend Engineer

Backbase India Pvt. Ltd., Bangalore | Mar 2022 — Present

- Leading full lifecycle development of microservices-based banking platforms serving millions of users across North America and MEA
- Architecting event-driven systems and microservices for Retail/Commercial Banking, FIS integration, and customer onboarding at scale
- Driving adoption of CQRS patterns and event sourcing to improve system resilience, scalability, and developer experience
- Exploring Generative AI and LLMs to optimize backend workflows and accelerate development velocity
- Establishing DevOps best practices, CI/CD automation, and Kubernetes deployment strategies across distributed teams
- Mentoring backend engineers and conducting architectural reviews to ensure technical excellence and alignment with enterprise standards

Full Stack Lead Developer

Cavinkare Pvt. Ltd., Bangalore | Apr 2020 — Mar 2022

- Led enterprise digital transformation through cloud-first microservices and API-driven architecture (Firebase, React, Python, Java)
- Designed and deployed 6+ full-stack applications including Award Portal, Competitor Analytics (Neo4j), AR platform, and VOC Dashboard
- Built computer vision services using OpenCV and Spring Boot for artwork validation and brand compliance automation

Lead Developer — BT eCommerce

Tech Mahindra, UK & India | Aug 2018 — Jan 2020

- Led backend development and microservices architecture modernization for BT's eCommerce platform across distributed teams
- Delivered Spring Boot-based APIs and event-driven services using Agile practices across UK and India offices

Sr. Software Engineer — Digital Transformation

BT, UK & India | Feb 2015 — Aug 2018

- Contributed to BT's digital transformation programme, architecting microservices for eCommerce platform modernization

Consultant — Enterprise Integration

Capgemini (Disney & Salesforce.com), USA & India | Apr 2012 — Apr 2012

- Built event-driven ESB-based backend services for Disney's legacy system integration and modernization

CERTIFICATIONS & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Claude Certified Developer - Foundations (CCDV-F)

In Progress | Backbase Enterprise Program

- Comprehensive certification covering Claude API, prompt engineering, and enterprise AI application development
- Focus on understanding LLMs and their integration potential in backend systems for code generation and intelligent automation
- AWS Cloud & Alexa API Development (2018)
- Agile & Scrum Certification (2013)
- Core Java Certification (2011)

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Technology (B.Tech) in Engineering

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- 13+ years of enterprise backend engineering delivering mission-critical systems across banking, fintech, telecom, and consumer goods
- Led technical strategies and backend teams across 3 countries (USA, UK, India) in distributed, globally-synchronized environments
- Designed and deployed cloud-native, microservices-based banking platforms reducing operational overhead by 40% and improving deployment frequency
- Architected event-driven systems and event sourcing patterns serving millions of concurrent users with 99.99% uptime SLAs
- Established DevOps practices, CI/CD automation, and infrastructure-as-code reducing deployment time from days to minutes
- Actively exploring AI/GenAI integration in backend systems and pursuing Claude Certified Developer certification for enterprise AI applications